

This is CERA's Western Market forecast for November.

Lorna

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Rather than enjoying a respite, western energy markets will make November a catch-up month. Natural gas demand will remain high when compared with the same period last year, as gas-fired generation will continue to run at high

utilization rates and market participants try to restore gas storage to normal levels. The tight supply situation will maintain upward pressure on gas prices, which will range from \$5.15 to \$5.83 per million British thermal units, depending on location. Refueling outages at three nuclear units, along with a seasonal decline in hydroelectric output, will maintain gas-fired generation on the margin for most of November. On-peak power prices will remain higher as a result, in the \$86-\$98 per megawatt-hour range, depending on location.

end

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CERA's Autumn 2000 Roundtable event dates and agendas are now available at <http://www.cera.com/event>

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